
The Morning: The melting continent

"The New York Times" <nytdirect@nytimes.com>

收件人: twb72743075@126.com

时 间: 2026-2-4 19:50:26

附 件:

[View in browser](#) | [nytimes.com](#)



The New York Times The Morning

February 4, 2026



By Sam Sifton

Good morning. Penny, a Doberman pinscher, won the Westminster Dog Show last night — the first of her breed to receive the best in show honor since 1989. ([See pictures](#) from the show here.)

And peace talks among the U.S., Russia and Ukraine [are taking place today](#) in the U.A.E.

There's more news below. I'm going to start today, though, at the very bottom of the world.



Chang W. Lee/The New York Times

The melting continent

Two days after Christmas, the Times journalists Raymond Zhong and Chang W. Lee set sail from Christchurch, New Zealand, on a research vessel bound for Antarctica. They've been there ever since, traveling with an international team

of scientists on a high-stakes expedition to study the continent's most unstable glacier.

They've sent back [gripping dispatches](#) (that's Ray's job) and [amazing images](#) (Chang captures those). Their work documents the scientists' research and lives, as well as the austere, beautiful and sometimes terrifying vistas around them. Thwaites, the glacier the scientists are studying, is a mass of ice that's roughly the size of Florida. The research is meant to help us understand how long it will be before it melts away, lifting sea levels around the world.



Chang W. Lee/The New York Times

Reporters from The Times have covered Antarctica for the better part of a century, and not from afar. (That's my job.) Russell Owen was on the continent for 14 months in the late 1920s, writing almost daily about a milestone expedition led by Richard E. Byrd, then a U.S. Navy commander. Later trips by Times reporters, most recently in 2016, brought our readers stories of discovery and science on and in the ice.

Ray and Chang have it pretty good, Ray told me yesterday when we caught up on a video call from the ship: good food, warm bunks, strong internet, an easy commute to work. Still, he said, it's Antarctica. Things go wrong.

Over the weekend, [Ray reported](#), the expedition suffered a significant setback when instruments the scientists were lowering down a half-mile hole in the glacier got stuck and then froze over. The idea had been to moor them in the sea below the glacier to monitor the warming water that's causing the glacier to slough ice and disappear. It was a gutting moment for the crew, Ray told me yesterday. As he wrote, "A project almost a decade in the making had crumbled at the final stage."



Chang W. Lee/The New York Times

But it's not as if the expedition has been a failure. The scientists bounced back quickly, and returned to work on the ship, Ray said. Disappointment often accompanies discovery, they know. It was never a certainty that the scientists would get any data at all, given the vicissitudes of weather and the ice itself. "They know what they signed up for," Ray said.

And they've gotten plenty of data, with more on the way before they depart this weekend. The scientists have flown helicopters equipped with radar antennas that have allowed them to find huge cracks in the ice and to map where and how the ice is breaking apart. They've tagged seals with sensors that essentially deputize the animals — they'll collect data on their deep ocean dives that will help scientists better understand the water's warming currents. They've placed instruments in ice rifts. And, Ray said, they'll be back to learn more when they can. Once you've experienced the majesty of Antarctica, it's hard to let it go.

“You get the bug,” he said. Has he? Ray laughed. “Oh, yeah.”



Chang W. Lee/The New York Times

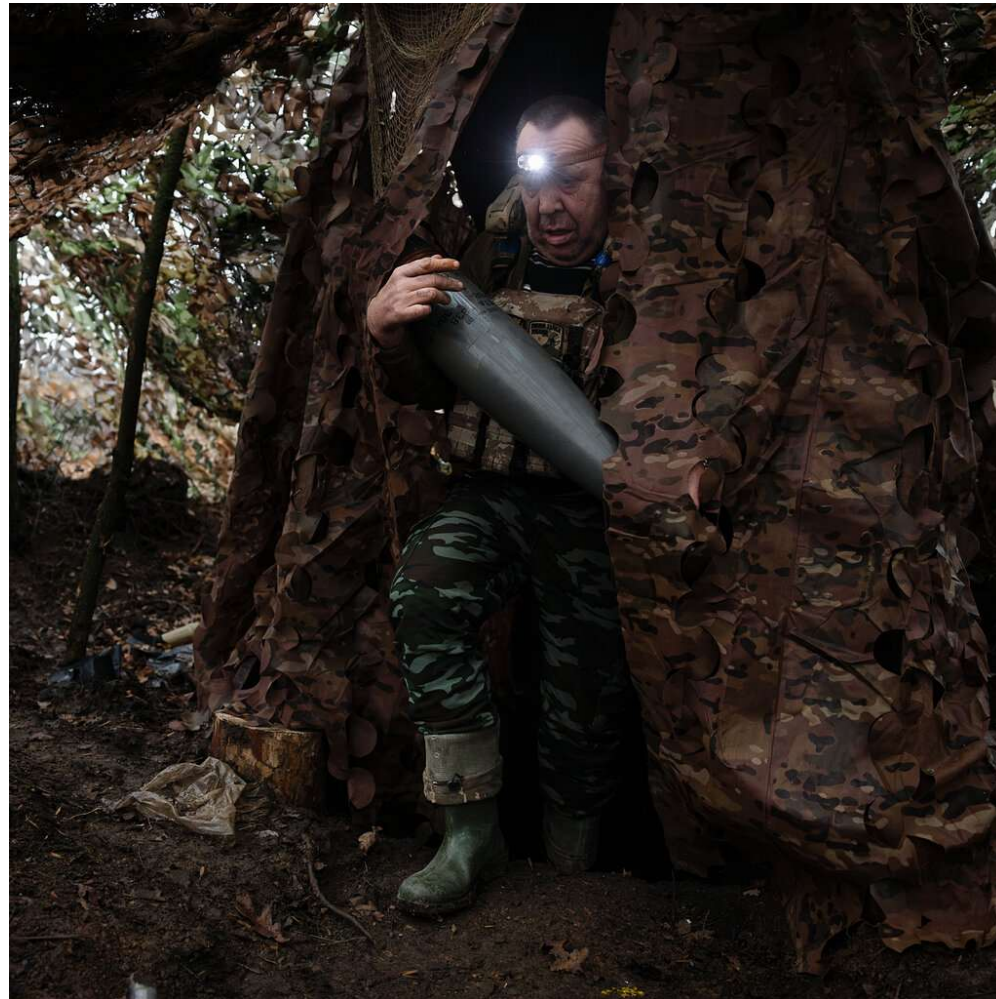
You can [read more about the expedition here](#).

Now, let's see what else is happening in the world.



THE LATEST NEWS

International



In the Donbas region. Tyler Hicks/The New York Times

Polls show that more Ukrainians [are considering the once unthinkable](#): surrendering land in exchange for peace.

A U.S. fighter jet [shot down an Iranian drone](#) that the American military said had aggressively approached an aircraft carrier in the Arabian Sea.

Spain's prime minister announced plans to bar children under 16 [from using social media](#), following Australia's lead. Other countries are also considering restrictions.

Immigration

Two new polls show that [most Republicans still support](#) President Trump's aggressive immigration enforcement tactics.

Two brothers of Renee Good [addressed lawmakers on Capitol Hill](#) about their sister's killing by an ICE agent in Minneapolis. One described her as "unapologetically hopeful."

For children in Minnesota, immigration raids are [fracturing their communities](#) and sense of security.

Do ICE agents need a warrant to enter someone's home? In the video below, Hamed Aleaziz, an immigration reporter, explains how the agency has broadened its own power.

St. Paul, Minn.
Jan. 18, 2026





The New York Times

More on Politics

Congress passed, and Trump signed, a bill to [reopen parts of the federal government](#), kicking off what are likely to be difficult negotiations over the scope of the administration's ICE crackdowns.

Trump doubled down on his extraordinary call for the Republican Party to [“nationalize”](#) voting in the United States.

Trump met privately with Colombia's president at the White House. The two leaders had verbally attacked each other for months, but Trump told reporters after the meeting they [“got along very well.”](#)

Political scientists are using the term “neoroyalism” [to describe Trump's approach to governing](#), which they say is based on personal ties rather than national interest.

Trump's abrupt two-year closure of the Kennedy Center has [rattled the institution's employees, performers and subscribers](#).

The president released new renderings of his White House ballroom and emphasized that [it would not be taller](#) than the Executive Mansion.

Journalists

Trump berated the CNN correspondent Kaitlan Collins in the Oval Office yesterday, [calling her “the worst reporter”](#) and scolding her for not smiling.

Don Lemon, the former CNN anchor who was arrested after covering a protest in Minnesota, told an audience in New York last night that he was not a protester [but would defend free speech](#).

Gender-Affirming Care

A plastic surgeons' group [recommended delaying gender-affirming procedures](#) until age 19, in contrast to the positions taken by most major U.S. medical associations.

A woman [won the first malpractice verdict](#) against providers of gender-affirming care for minors. She said a double mastectomy she received as a teenager had left her disfigured.

Business

Walmart is now [worth more than \\$1 trillion](#). It joins a small club of companies, including tech giants like Apple and Microsoft.

Disney's next C.E.O. will be Josh D'Amaro, a company veteran who [recently ran its theme parks](#).

Other Big Stories

Days after the disappearance of Nancy Guthrie, the 84-year-old mother of the "Today" show anchor Savannah Guthrie, the police said they were [investigating it as a possible kidnapping](#). Guthrie [withdrew from NBC's Olympics coverage](#) as the search continues.

The ex-husband of Jill Biden was [arrested and charged with murder](#) in the death of his wife, the police said.



The New York Times

Laughter is fundamental to [how babies learn about the world](#), writes **Gina Mireault**, a developmental psychologist.

Here is a column by **Jamelle Bouie** on what happens when [a president will not find common ground](#).

The Times Sale ends soon: Expand your knowledge with our experts.

Take advantage of our best offer and gain understanding and insight in every area of life. Just [\\$1 a week for your first year](#) of unlimited access to news, culture, cooking and more.



MORNING READS



Amir Hamja; Lanna Apisukh for The New York Times

Brushing, panting, licking: [See photos from backstage](#) at the Westminster Dog Show, where the dogs could let down their fur before taking to the ring.

A closer look: Researchers [are doing virtual autopsies on mummies](#) using high-resolution CT scans and 3-D printers.

Your pick: The most-clicked link in The Morning yesterday was about [how to make and keep friends](#).

The “Lobster Lady”: Virginia Oliver, a Maine folk hero, fished off the New England coast for more than 80 years. and continued almost until she died at 105. [See photos of her life here](#).



TODAY'S NUMBER

15

— *That is the height, in feet, of a bronze gold-leafed statue of Trump that's meant to be installed at his golf complex in Doral, Fla. [It's known as “Don Colossus.”](#)*

SPORTS

Olympics: Lindsey Vonn, the U.S. Alpine skiing star, said she [would try to compete](#) at the Milan-Cortina Olympics despite tearing her A.C.L. during a World Cup race in Switzerland last week.

N.F.L.: Robert Kraft, who has owned the New England Patriots during their six Super Bowl wins, [will not be selected](#) into the Pro Football Hall of Fame's 2026 class, a league source says.

RECIPE OF THE DAY



Frozen dumplings — like frozen rice cakes, frozen crinkle-cut Nathan's fries and frozen homemade lobster stock — are an invaluable asset for weeknight cooking. Hetty Lui McKinnon's new recipe gives them a Cantonese [salt-and-pepper treatment](#) usually reserved for seafood and stir-fries them with green beans. If you're eating the dish with rice (I am), make sure to get it going before you start cooking the potstickers. The work goes fast.

MISS PIGGY'S WORLD



Molly Matalon for The New York Times

A new single-episode edition of “The Muppet Show” premieres today on Disney+ and ABC. James Poniewozik, our television critic, [has a rave](#): “There’s no newfangled hook, no contrived rationalization to bring the characters up to date,” he writes. “There are songs and slapstick and jokes, and nobody, blessedly, stayed up too late thinking about the reasons why. (Because Muppets, that’s why.)”

In advance of watching it, catch up with Miss Piggy (and Eric Jacobson, the puppeteer who plays her). [The glamorous sow is having a moment](#).

More on culture

A.O. Scott, a critic for our Book Review, took on a surprising assignment: He gave a close read of a federal judge’s fanged and witty decision that challenged the Trump administration’s theory of executive power and freed a 5-year-old boy. It’s an example of the role literary critics play in society, using plain language and keen insight to help the rest of us understand texts that otherwise might be left overlooked or misunderstood. [Please read it](#).

“Is the golden era of Jewish comedy coming to an end?” That’s the question our comedy critic, Jason Zinoman, took up this week. His conclusion: [Not so fast](#).

Late night hosts [joked about the alternative Super Bowl halftime show](#).

THE MORNING RECOMMENDS

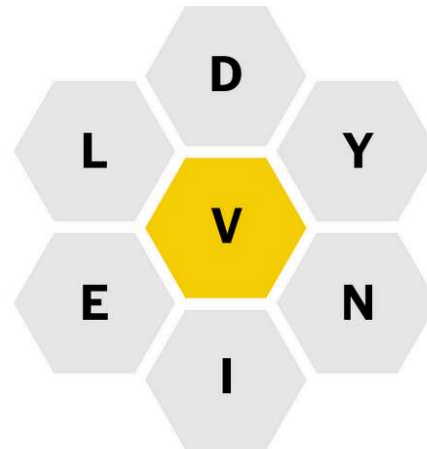
Read “Good People,” by Patmeena Sabit. The novelist Tommy Orange, who knows a thing or two about quality writing, [reviewed it for The Times](#). He calls the novel “a haunting, beautifully controlled exploration of what happens when the life you have built is dismantled by the very people you hoped would call you a friend.”

Start a new fitness routine with these [tips for beginners](#).

Warm yourself stylishly with [the best electric blankets](#) tested by the plugged-in sleep experts at Wirecutter.



GAMES



Here is [today's Spelling Bee](#). Yesterday's pangram was *dramatic*.

And here are [today's Mini Crossword](#), [Wordle](#), [Connections](#), [Sports Connections](#) and [Strands](#).

***Thanks for spending part of your morning with The Times and me.
See you tomorrow. — Sam***

Reach our team at themorning@nytimes.com.



Host: Sam Sifton

Editor: Adam B. Kushner

News Editor: Tom Wright-Piersanti

Associate Editor: Lauren Jackson

News Staff: Evan Gorelick, Brent Lewis, Lara McCoy, Karl Russell

Saturday Writer: Melissa Kirsch

Editorial Director, Newsletters: Jodi Rudoren

If you received this newsletter from someone else, [subscribe here](#).

Need help? Review our [newsletter help page](#) or [contact us](#) for assistance.

You received this email because you signed up for the Morning newsletter from The New York Times, or as part of your New York Times account.

To stop receiving The Morning, [unsubscribe](#). To opt out of other promotional emails from The Times, including those regarding The Athletic, [manage your email settings](#).

[Subscribe to The Times](#)

Connect with us on:



[Change Your Email](#) | [Privacy Policy](#) | [Contact Us](#) | [California Notices](#)

Ads powered by  ZETA | AdChoices 

The New York Times Company. 620 Eighth Avenue New York, NY 10018
